

ICAR-Indian Institute of Wheat and Barley Research, Karnal

Major advisory (Dec 01-15, 2025)

for

Sowings and other practices across zones of India

Crop Season 2025-26

Wheat sowing has progressed rapidly across the country, supported by favourable soil moisture and widespread adoption of machine sowing, which saves time, seed and labour. Farmers who have not yet planted are advised to select varieties very carefully, based on sowing time and the agro-climatic condition to get optimum yields. Farmers are advised to select high-yielding, climate-resilient varieties suitable for their sowing window and irrigation conditions, and always procure seed from reliable sources.

Farmers who sowed wheat in October, timely weed management and irrigation is essential to ensure robust crop establishment. Regular field monitoring is important to detect any early pest or disease incidence and maintain a healthy crop.

For wheat sown in the first week of November, emphasis should be given on ensuring proper crop emergence and scheduling the first irrigation after 20–25 days to promote uniform stand establishment.

General Tips

- ✓ Select a variety that suits late planting in your region and avoid using varieties from other zones to reduce the risk of disease susceptibility.
- ✓ Application of Nitrogen dose should be completed up to 40-45 days after sowing. Apply urea just before irrigation.
- ✓ Use optimal inputs and apply irrigation judiciously to maximize yield while saving water and reducing cost.
- ✓ There are many reasons for yellowing in wheat, if there is yellowing in the crop, do not use excessive nitrogen (urea). Also, avoid the use of nitrogen in fog or cloudy conditions.
- ✓ Keep an eye on the weather before irrigation and avoid irrigation if there is a forecast of rain so that the situation of excess water can be avoided.
- ✓ Regularly monitor the crop for rust infection and consult nearby institute, SAU or KVK.
- ✓ In case of late harvest of the previous crop, the residue should be retained or incorporated in the soil and should not be burnt. In the presence of loose crop residue retained on the soil surface, Happy seeder or Smart seeder can be used for seeding wheat. This will avoid any further delay in wheat sowing and will increase the soil carbon content.
- ✓ In conservation till wheat, top dressing of urea should be done just before irrigation.

Wheat Varieties for late, very late sowing in Northern, Eastern & Central India

Variety	Production conditions	Zone
Late Sown Varieties		
PBW752, PBW771, DBW173, JKW261, HD3059, WH1021	Irrigated, late sown Upto December 25	NWPZ: Punjab, Haryana, Part of Rajasthan, West UP
DBW316, PBW833, DBW107, HD3118, JKW261, PBW 752		NEPZ: East UP, Bihar, Bengal, Jharkhand
HD3407, HI1634, CG1029, MP3336,		CZ: MP, Gujarat, Rajasthan

Sowing time, seed rate and fertilizer application: The wheat crop in different agro-climatic zones and production conditions has slight variation from zone to zone and under varying production conditions.

Zone-wise sowing seed rate and fertilizer dose for wheat crop

Zone	Sowing conditions	Seed rate	Fertilizer doses and time of application
NWPZ and NEPZ	Irrigated late sown	125 kg/ha	120:60:40 kg NPK /ha (1/3 N and full P & K as basal at sowing and remaining N in two equal splits at first and second irrigation)
CZ and PZ	Irrigated late sown	125 kg/ha	90:60:40 kg NPK /ha (1/3 N and full P & K as basal at sowing and remaining N in two equal splits at first and second irrigation)

Weed management (Herbicide Spray)

- To control narrow leaf weeds in wheat, apply Clodinafop 15 WP @ 160 gm per acre or Pinoxaden 5 EC @ 400 ml per acre at around 35 days after sowing. To control broad leaf weeds, spray 2,4-D 500 ml/acre or metsulfuron 20 WP at 8 grams per acre or carfentrazone 40 DF at 20 g/acre at around 35 days after sowing.
- If there are both narrow and broad leaf weeds in wheat field then use Sulfosulfuron 75 WG @ 13.5 gm/acre or Sulfosulfuron+Metsulfuron 80 WG at 16 gm/acre in 120-150liters of water before the first irrigation or 10-15 days after irrigation. Alternatively, mesosulfuron + iodosulfuron 3.6%WDG @ 160 gm/acre can also be applied for control of diverse weed flora in wheat.
- For control of multiple herbicide resistant Phalaris minor (Kanaki/Gulli Danda), spray Pyroxasulfone 85 WG at the rate of 60 grams/acre alone or in combination with pendimethalin 30 EC 2.0 lit/acre 0-3 days after sowing or Spray ready mix combination of Aclonifen 450 + diflufenican 75 + pyroxasulfone 50 (Mateno More) @ 800 ml/acre 0-3 days after sowing using 150-200 lit of water or Spray ready mix combination of clodinafop + metribuzin 12+42% WP at 200 g/acre at 10-15 days after first irrigation using 120-150 lit of water.
- Pyroxasulfone 85 WG @ 60 grams/acre can also be applied at 20 days after sowing i.e. 1-2 days before first irrigation, if it was not applied at the time of sowing.
- For early sown high fertility conditions wheat, first spray of tank mix combinations of Chlormequat chloride 50% SL at 0.2% of commercial product + tebuconazole 25.9% EC at 0.1% of commercial product may be done at first node stage (50-55 DAS) using 160 lit/acre of water.

Irrigation

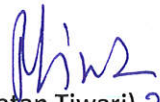
- Farmers are advised to do first irrigation after 20-25 days of sowing.

Termite Control: For late sown crop, in the termite prone areas, seed treatment with chloropyriphos @ 0.9g a.i /kg seed (4.5 ml product dose / kg seed), be taken up for their management. Seed treatment with thiamethoxam 70WS (Cruiser 70WS) @ 0.7 g a.i./kg seed (4.5 ml product dose / kg seed) or Fipronil (Regent 5FS @ 0.3 g a.i./kg seed or 4.5 ml product dose / kg seed) is also very effective.

For timely sown, apply it with irrigation water if attack of termite is visible.

Pink stem borer control: The incidence of pink stem borer is observed more in fields of rice-wheat cropping system where wheat is sown in zero tillage fields. For its management, foliar spray of quinalphos (Ecalux) 800 ml /acre as soon as pink stem borer is seen. Irrigation also helps in reducing the pink stem borer damage.

Advice for yellow rust disease: Farmers are advised to regularly inspect their wheat crop for early detection of stripe rust (yellow rust) and brown rust. In case rust symptoms are suspected, confirmation should be ensured first, as early yellowing in the field may sometimes be mistaken for yellow rust. For proper diagnosis, farmers are encouraged to contact the nearest Agriculture department/KVK.


(Ratan Tiwari) 28/11/25
Director